Hello! I am **Pahul** running **Studioundertrees**, an experimental architecture firm.

In my practise I try to focus on the philosophy of design and how materials in a space makes us feel.

Further on you will go through some of the works I have done in past.





Project name: Shangrila Resort
Location: Ombey, Ladakh
In collab.with Guild Studios

The project included two six room cottages, restaurants and a reception.

Client wanted the property to run all round the year. Therefore, we implemented a passive solar design. For winters season Trombe Wall construction was used. Windows are provided on the south facade to trap maximum heat. Walls are made out of insitu CSEB bricks.

Image1-2 a physical model of the cluster to make our client and mistri visualise it.







Image1 on top left: Trombe wall for the toilets, to not let the water pipes freeze in winters.

Image2 bottom left: Our carpenter for the project from Punjab.

Image3 top right: The mistri who learned and made Cseb bricks on site after too many different soil combinations.



Ground floor construction. The finishing was done in traditional Ladakhi plaster by combing fingers on thick mud plaster.



Thin willow sticks called Talu is used for the boundary of verandah area in cottages.



Project name: Apple Orchard
Location: Hunder, Ladakh
In collab.with Guild Studios

This project was on a beautiful site all surrounded by apple trees. The brief was to design and build six cottages, where three had open shower.

In the walls the brick bond had gap in between which was filled with leftover wood shavings for better insulation. Turning it into another passive solar building.







Image1 top left: The complete view of the cottage. Here we can see the climbing steps, verandah and the huge entry window.

Image2 bottom left: The curves implemented in this project.

Image3 top right: The wall behind the bed is made out of arranging local colorful stones with white cement.









Project name: Bauhaus Kumaon Dormitory
Location: Near Almora, Uttarakhand
In collab. with Earthbuilding, Ladakh

Here we had designed Dorms, Cottages and public spaces like dining, workshop and kitchen.

The clients brief and our choice was to make everything out of natural materials available in the mountains. Stones for foundation, plinth, mud bricks for the walls, pine wood for tie beams and fenestrations, tin sheet (budget constraint) with bubble insulation below it and final finish with lime. For the toilet area we used burnt bricks binded with lime mortar.







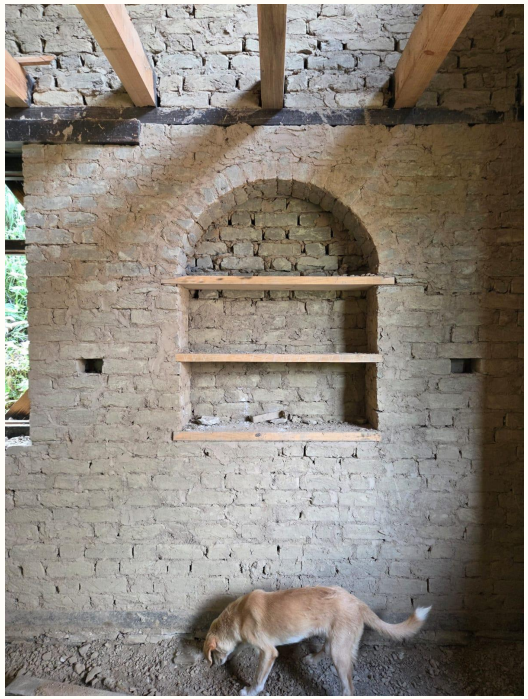




Image 1: At the plinth and lintel lvl. tie beams are made out of pine wood. Kintsugi (tradition japanese trick) the exterior of the wood is burnt to suck out the remaining sap.
Image2: Alcoves traditional Kumaoni architecture
Image3: Lime preparation for mortar.
Image4: Floor beams for attic space.
Image5: Adobe brick sample



Project name: Green Tara Gompa
Location: Hunder, Ladakh
In collab with Guild studios

A public project for the people of Hunder village. On it’s right flows the beautiful Hunder river whereas the left side is guided by Nubra mountains.

Yamangas (local slate) was used on base flooring and roofing. White Sumur(region in Ladakh) stones put together using mud mortar.





Project name: Kangri Chaupal
Location: Nagrota Bagwan, HP
Independent

In Kangra valley the locals have been drastically brainwashed to construct new red brick houses and leave their old mud ones. The clients brief revolved around this.

He wanted to make pilot project showcasing the vernacular architecture of Himachal. We came up with an idea of designing a 1500sqft community space, where local Ngo's can conduct meetings and host workshops.





This was a first independent project by Studio Under Trees.

A few construction details-

Foundation-2’6”, Stone
Plinth-2’6”, Stone
Tie beam-3”x4” pine wood
Wall-18”Adobe bricks
Sill beam-3”x4” pine wood
Lintel beam-3”x4” pine wood
Fenestrations- Bamboo
Roofing beams- H-15’, Bamboo
Roofing-Slate
Glass skylight

All the materials were available in the radius of 10km which saved us some cost.

Image1: South east view
Image2: West view





The winter north winds, heat insulation below the slate roof, summer sun and other important strategies were kept in mind while designing.

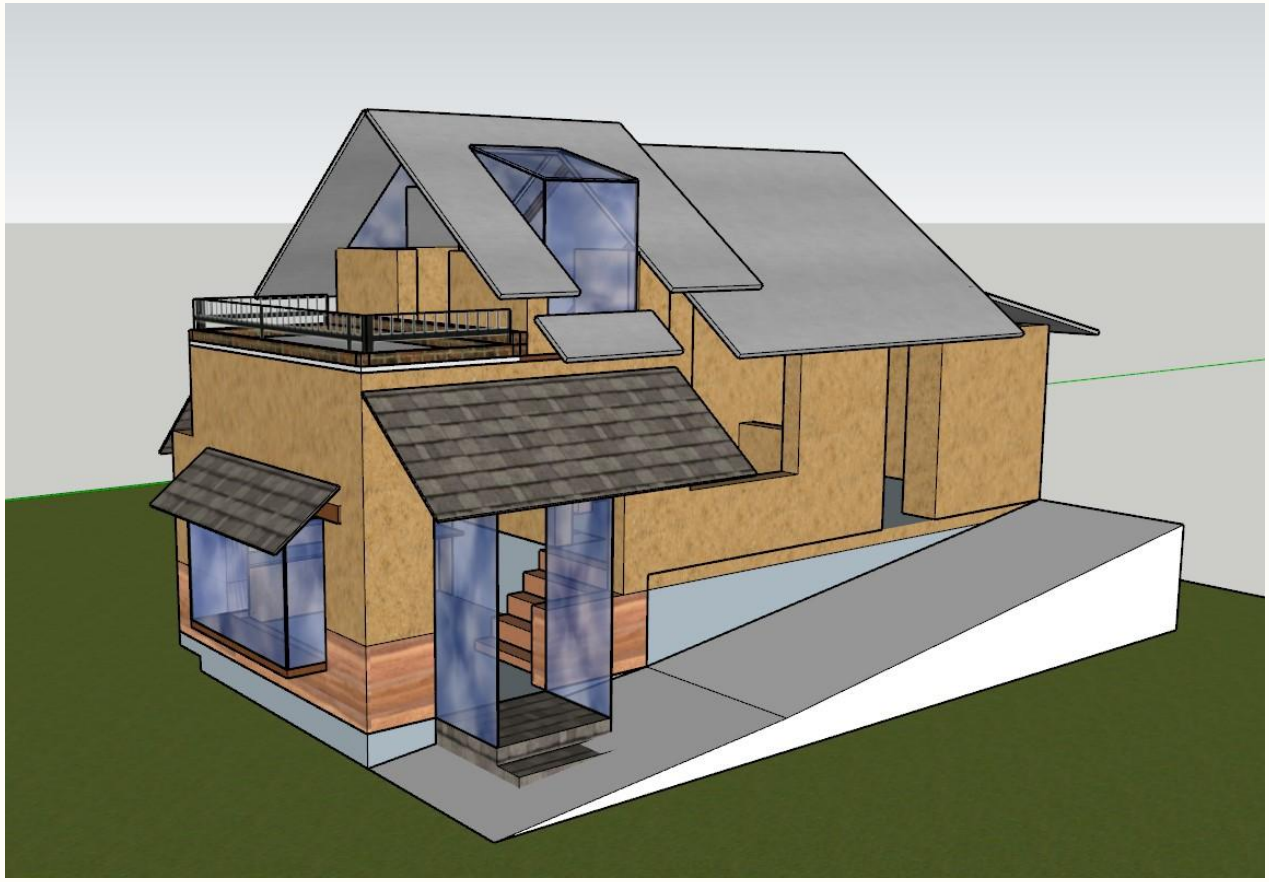
To make it an economical project the shutters were also proposed to be made out of bamboo, as it is locally available in abundance.

The side showcasing the rammed earth wall is the projection area. From here the public inside the space can see the snowy peaks of Dhauladhar ranges.

This project did not reach the construction stage. Only the adobe brick samples were ready.

Image1 and 2- Interior images, proposed two options.

Now i want to learn more…..



Project name: Ira’s hideway
Homestay cottage

Location: Kandabadi, HP

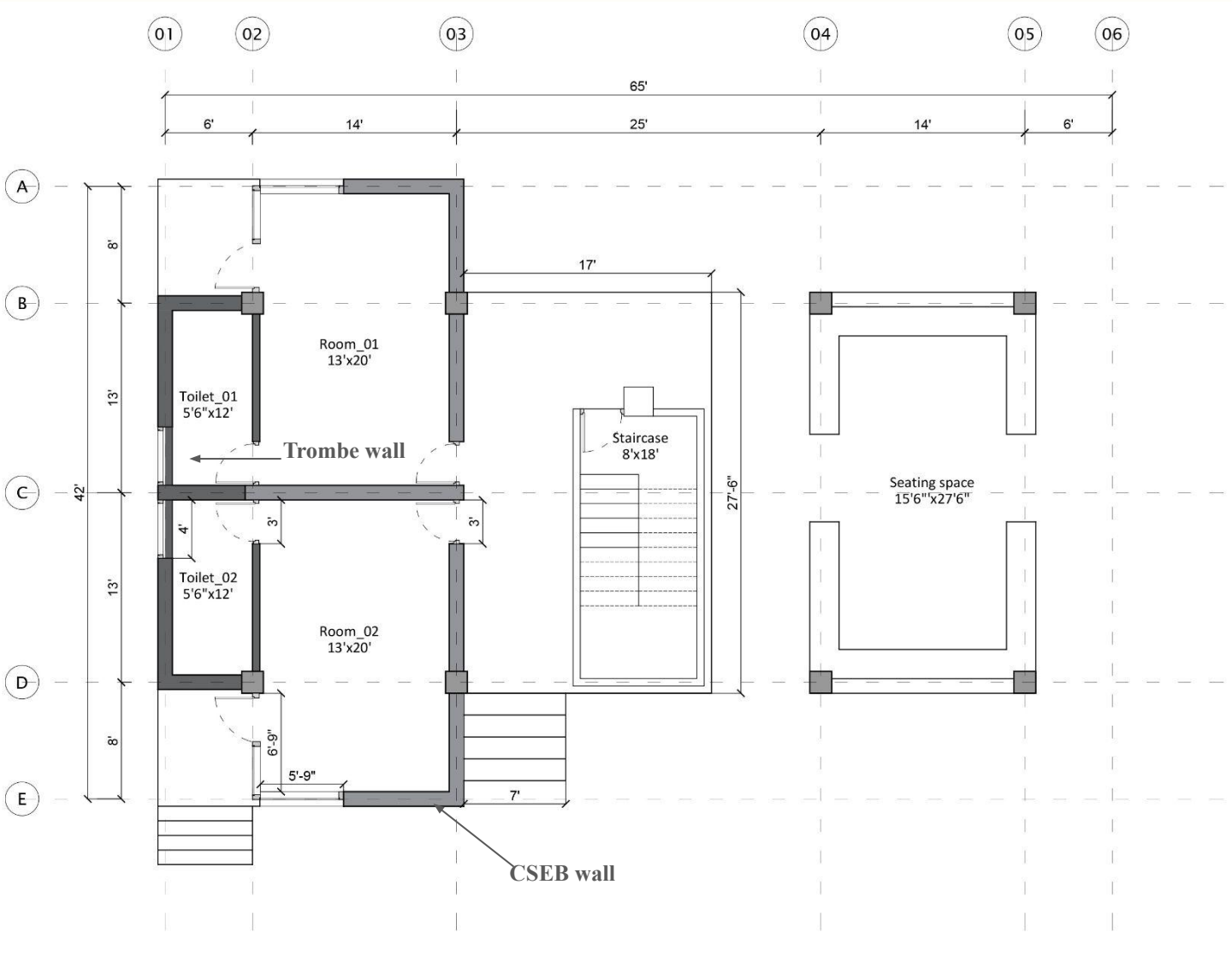


Front view

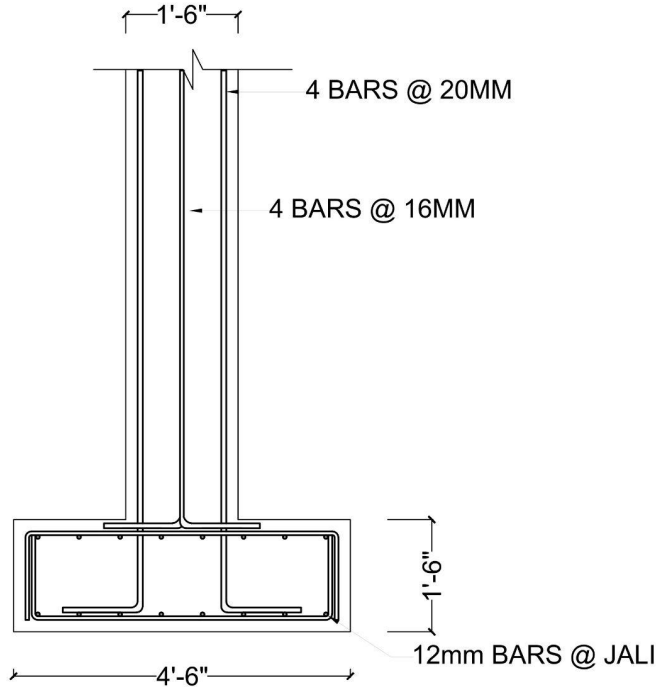


Designed this 800sqft cottage for a friend who runs an eco-friendly homestay. Here, the skeleton was already built in concrete and metal pipes which made it a challenge to do any alteration. The cottage had kitchen, bedroom, washroom, attic and balcony space.

The village women along with other volunteers made adobe bricks.

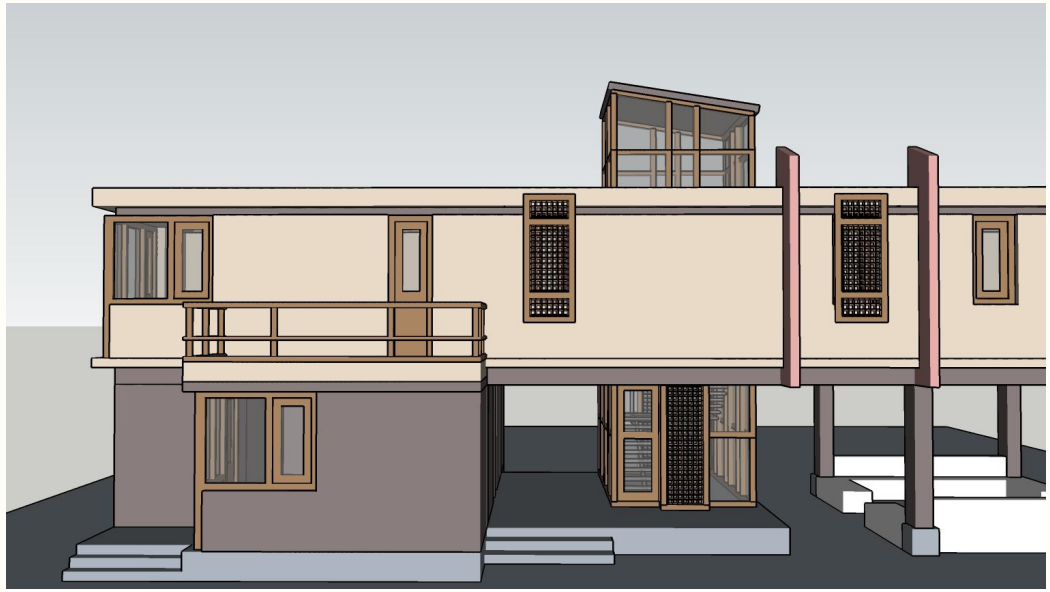


Ground floor plan of single cluster



Footing section





3D model of one of the clusters.
Windows are give on the south facade
while the north has open space for
gatherings.







The reception of the resort. I have designed the structure keeping in mind the existence of these two huge willow trees. The design has a floating roof, fins of CSEB bricks and dry stone masonry.

My part: Designing (Site construction not yet started)







Project name: Apple Cottage
Location: Hunder, Ladakh

A mud plastered passive solar building with walls filled with wood waste for insulation. The key highlight is the skylight over the bed and in-built furniture to save space. The stone wall behind the bed is made out of locally sourced stones.

My part: Design inputs, interior and complete site construction.















The stone wall behind the bed is made out of locally sourced stones.



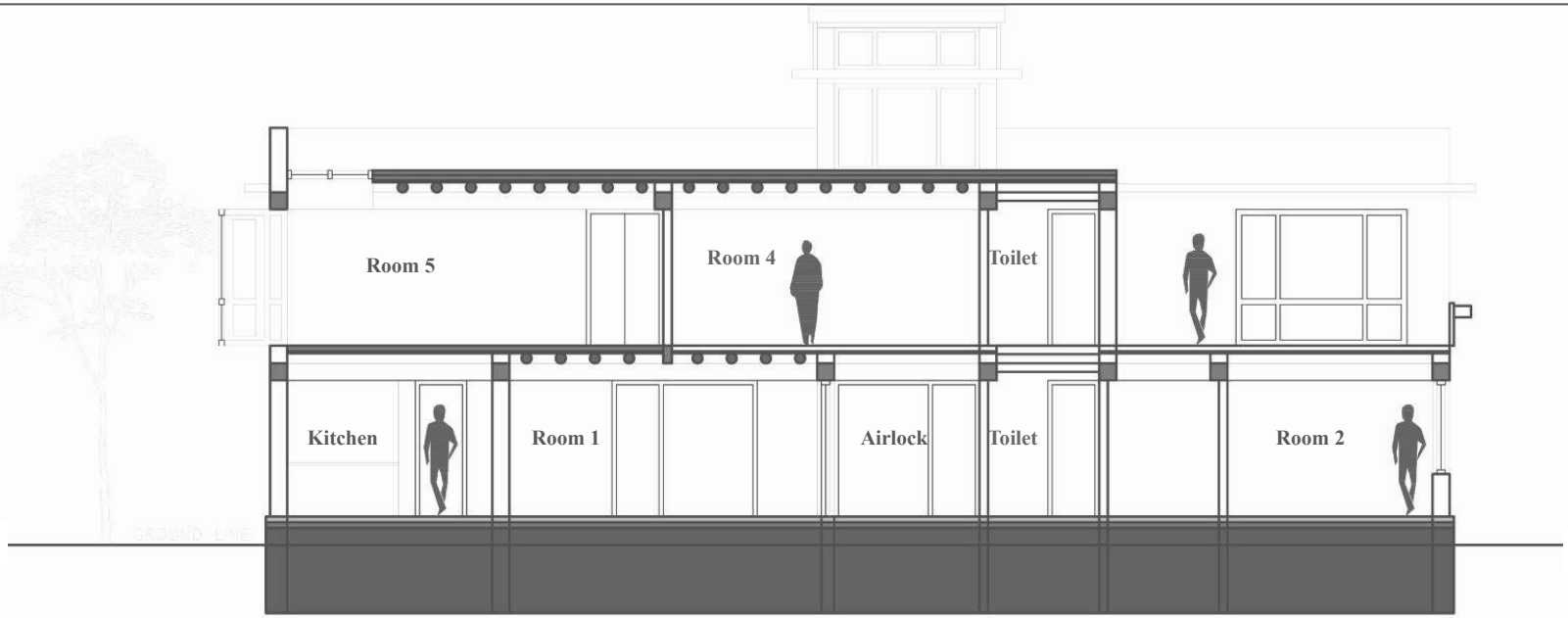
Project name: Rigzen residence
Location: Thiksey, Ladakh

This project is designed by keeping in mind the vernacular architecture of Ladakh. Rabsal (outer bay window sitting) is the key feature to this. It is a Passive solar house with trombe walls for toilets.

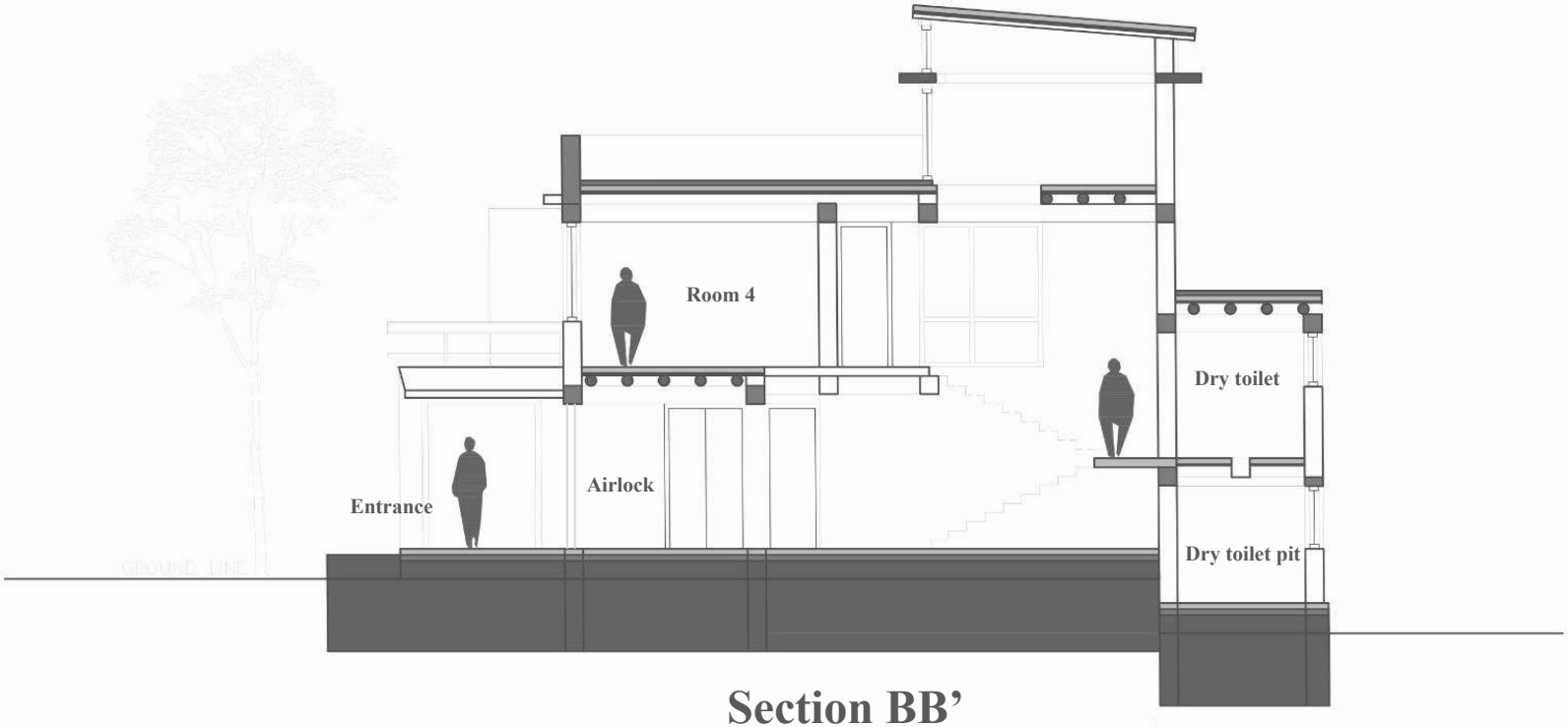
My part: Construction dwgs.



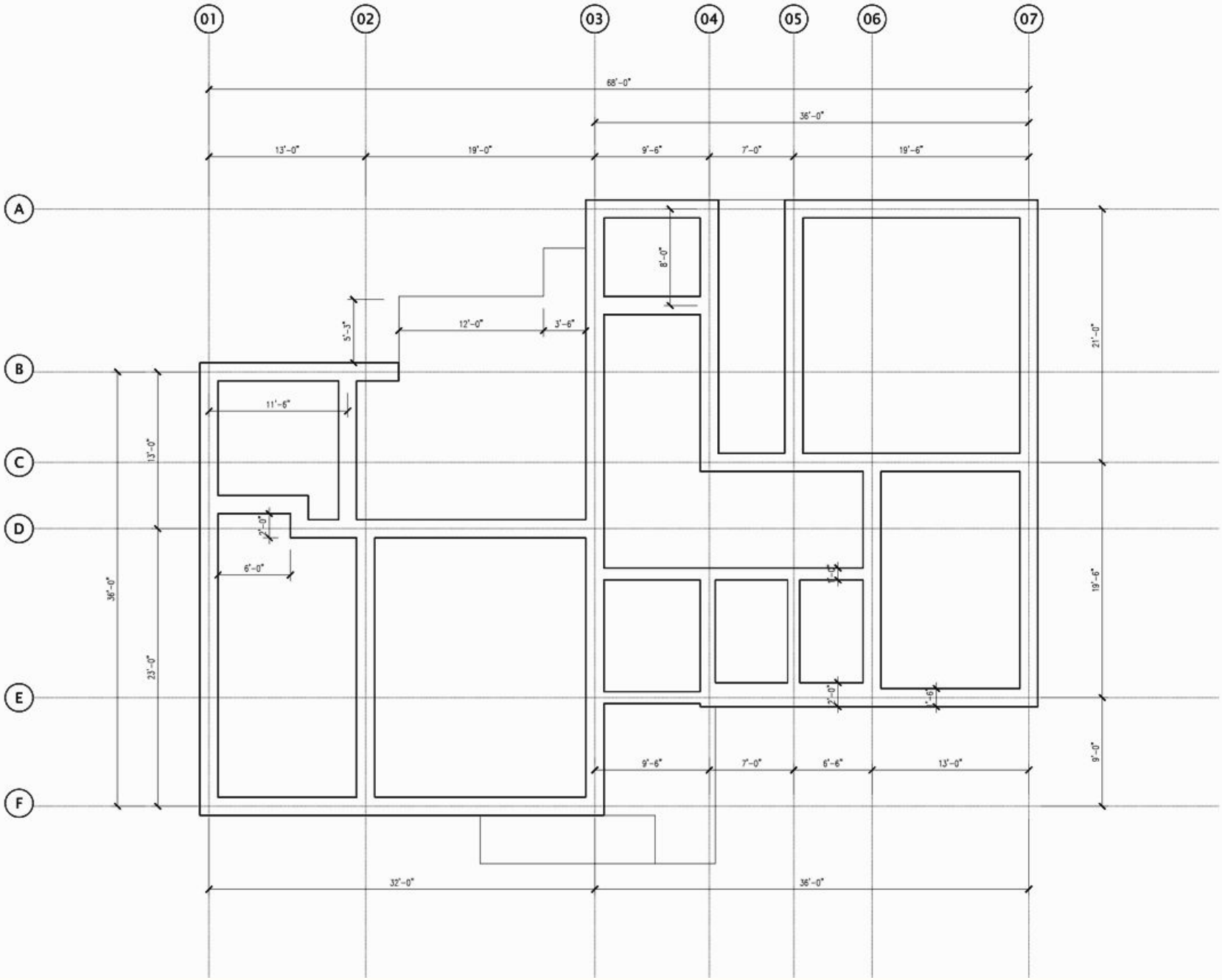




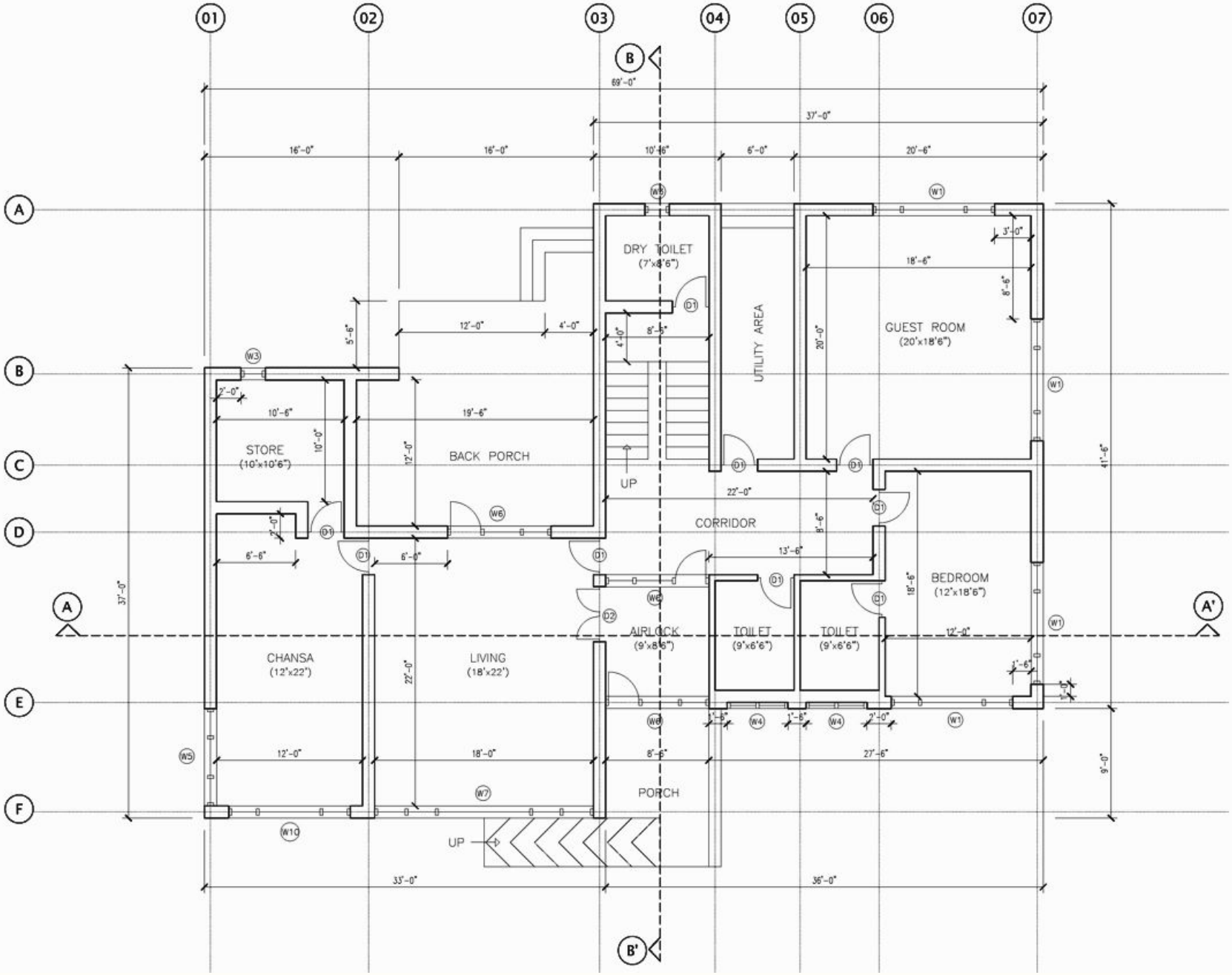
Section AA’



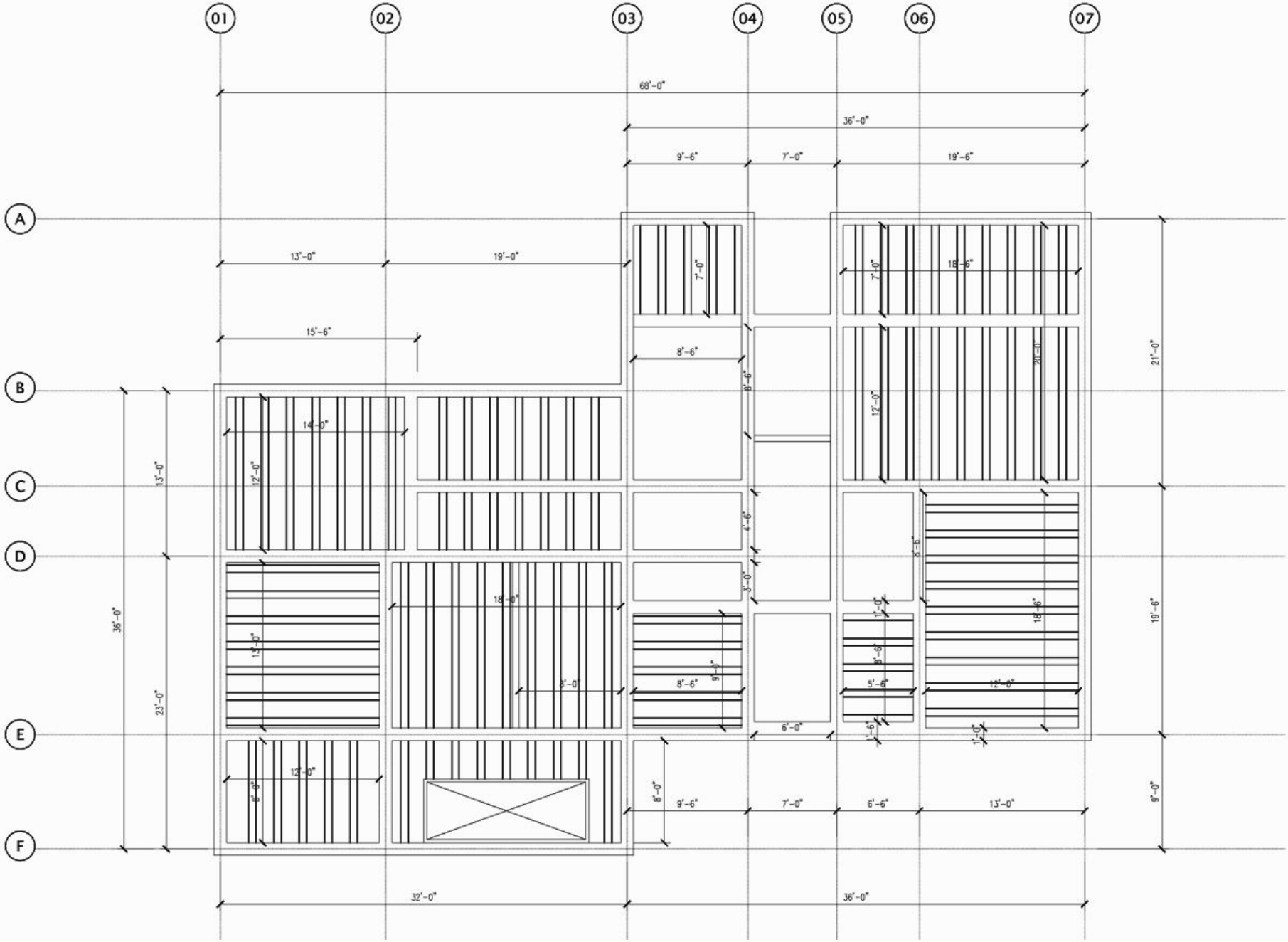
Section BB’



Foundation drawing plan.



Ground floor plan



Dugma and beam layout plan



Project name: Hotel interior
Location: Diskit, Ladakh

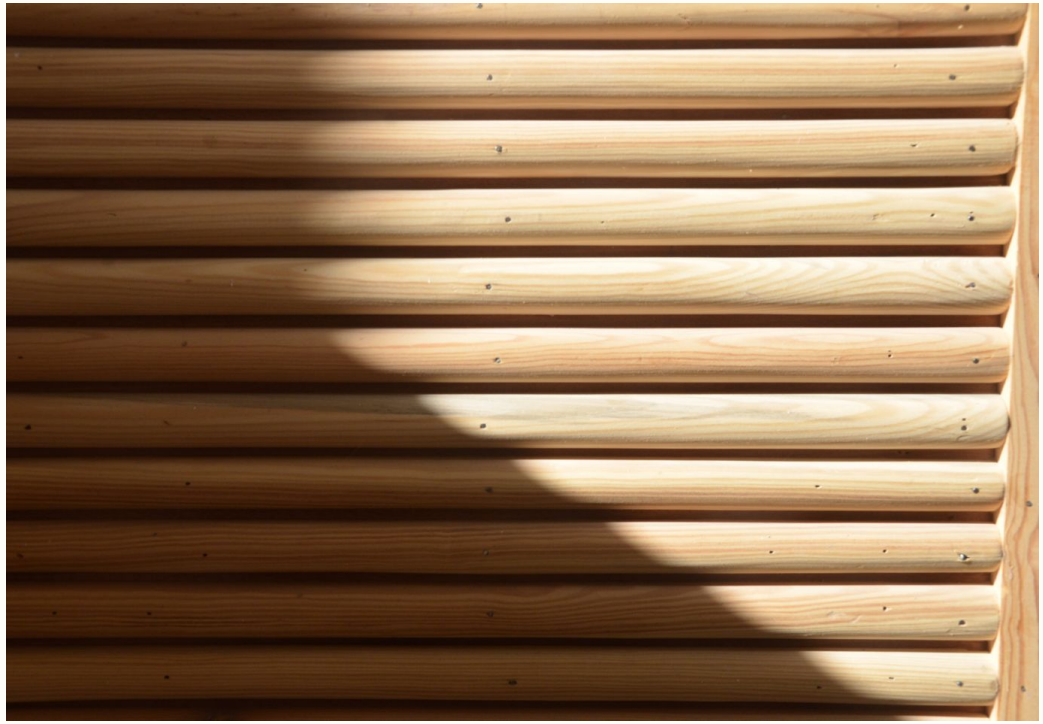
The furniture was designed keeping in mind the local wooden joinery of Ladakh. Silver kale and German KD woods were used. In this we have designed buffet, reception tables, wooden partitions etc,

My part: Design inputs and complete site construction



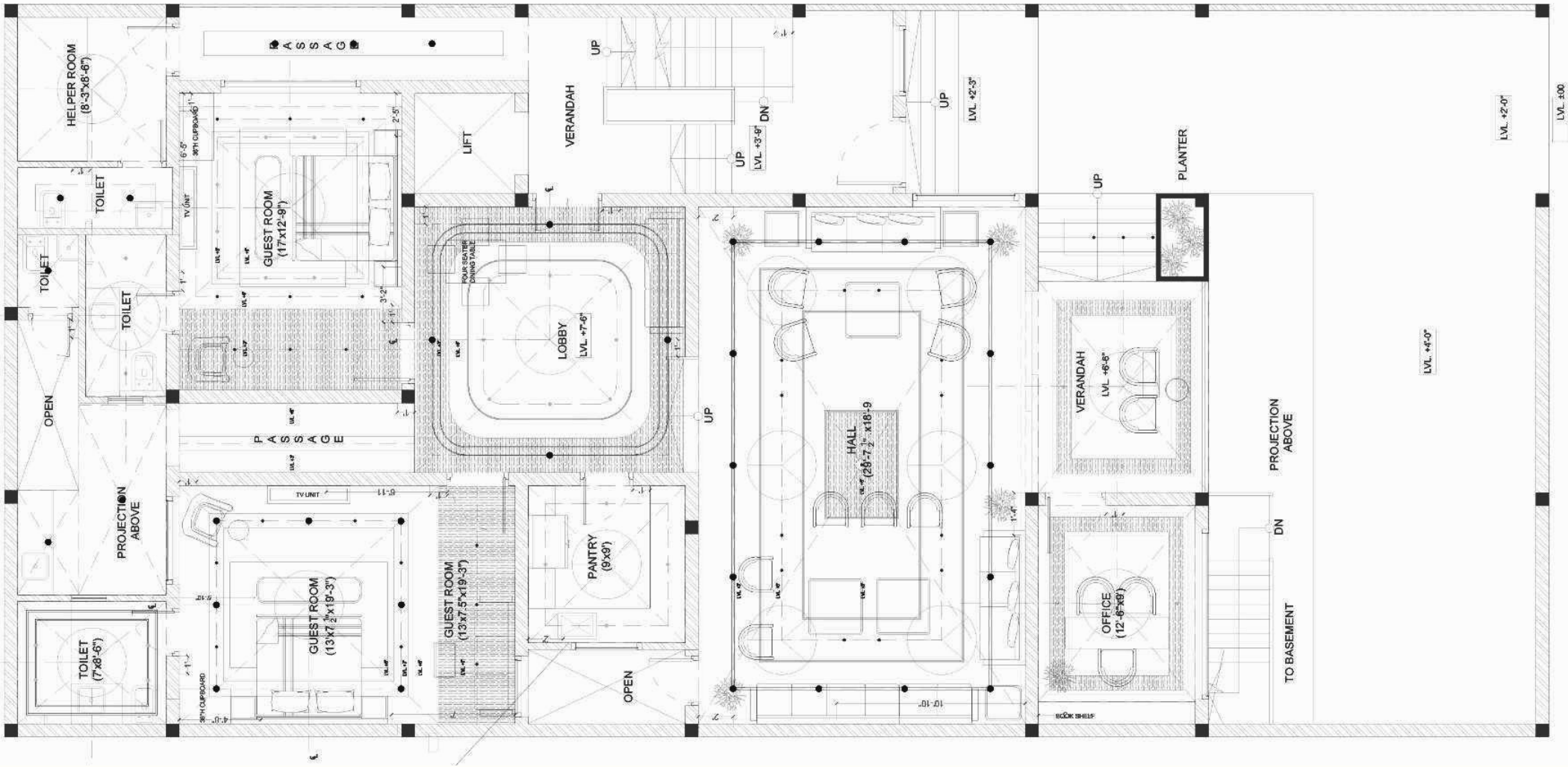








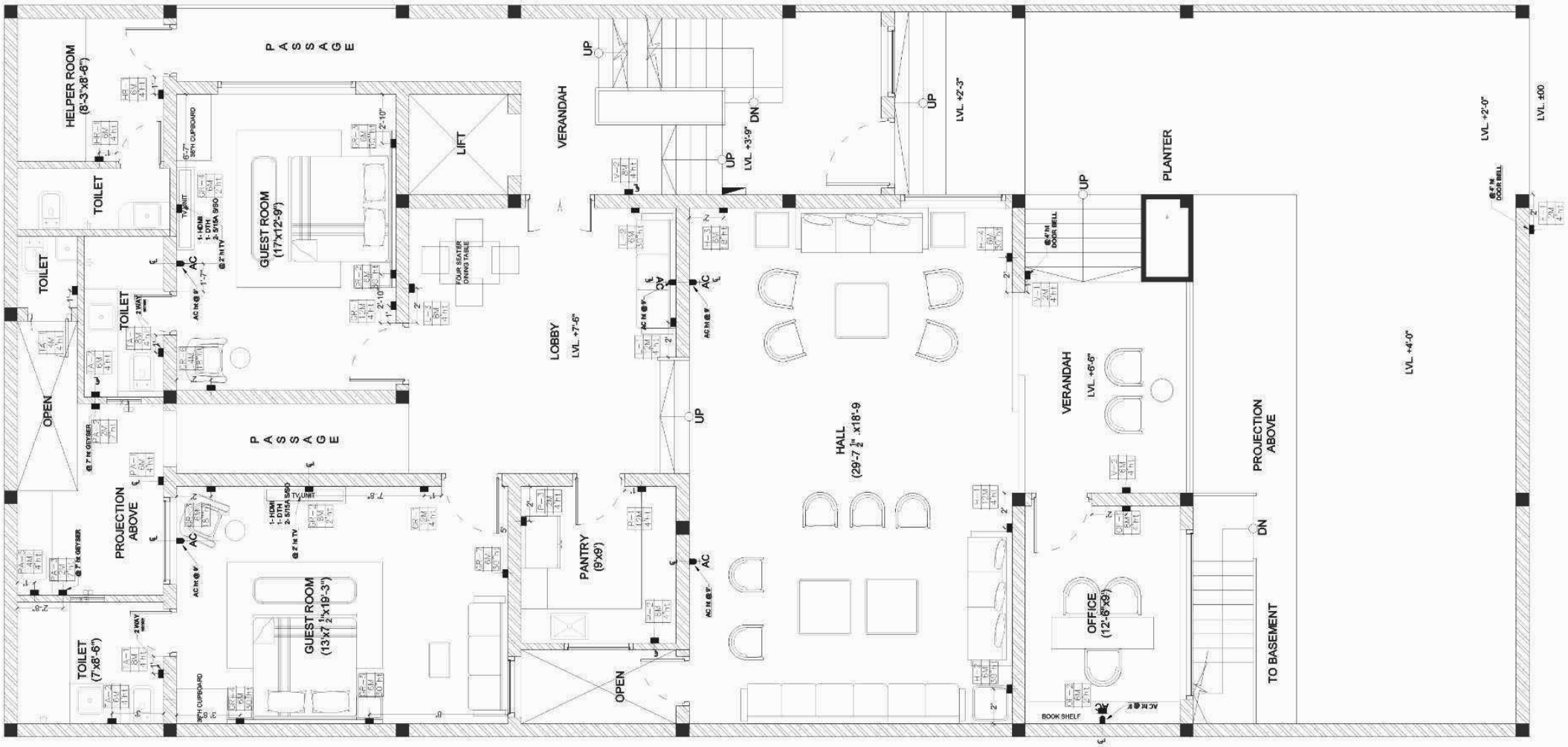




Ground floor false ceiling plan

Project name: Baraut residence

Location: Meerut



Ground floor electrical plan

Project name: Baraut residence

Location: Meerut

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